

Yigit Ekin

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Education

Bilkent University

July 2023 – January 2026

M.S. in Computer Engineering

- Thesis: [Controllable Diffusion-Based Visual Editing](#)
- Supervised by [Prof. Aysegul Dundar](#)
- **Departmental Scholarship** covering full tuition

Bilkent University

July 2019 – June 2023

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering; **Honor Student**

Publications

- **The Unreasonable Effectiveness of Text Embedding Interpolation for Continuous Image Steering.**
Yigit Ekin, Yossi Gandelsman.
NeurIPS 2026. [Paper](#) · [Project Page](#) · [Code](#)
- **BeyondMasks: Evaluating Causal and Physical Consistency in Video Object Removal.**
Yigit Ekin, Enes Sanli, Aykut Erdem, Erkut Erdem, Aysegul Dundar.
ECCV 2026. [Paper](#) · [Project Page](#) · [Code](#) · [Dataset](#)
- **RoPECraft: Training-Free Motion Transfer with Trajectory-Guided RoPE Optimization on Diffusion Transformers.**
Ahmet Berke Gokmen*, Yigit Ekin*, Bahri Batuhan Bilecen*, Aysegul Dundar.
*Equal contribution. *NeurIPS 2025*. [Paper](#) · [Project Page](#) · [Code](#)
- **CLIPAway: Harmonizing Focused Embeddings for Removing Objects via Diffusion Models.**
Yigit Ekin, Ahmet Burak Yildirim, Erdem Eren Çağlar, Aykut Erdem, Erkut Erdem, Aysegul Dundar.
NeurIPS 2024. [Paper](#) · [Project Page](#) · [Code](#)
- **MixGAN: Dual Path StyleGAN Fusion for Diverse and Editable Inpainting.**
Mustafa Utku Aydogdu, Ahmet Burak Yildirim, Yigit Ekin, Aysegul Dundar.
Manuscript under review.

Research Experience

Research Scientist, [fal.ai](#)

October 2026 – Present

- Work on **post-training large-scale diffusion models** for image and video generation.

Research Intern, [Reve AI](#)

February 2026 – August 2026

Worked with [Yossi Gandelsman](#); research team now part of [OpenAI's multimodal team](#).

- Co-developed **Diffusion Sliders** for continuous image steering without per-concept training, using LLM-generated contrastive prompts and automatic steering-range calibration.
- Contributed to datasets and implementation supporting [Reve 2.0](#) and [Reve 2.1](#).
- Designed training and architecture experiments for internal LLMs and VLMs; studied multimodal data mixtures and fine-tuning strategies while preserving language and reasoning performance.
- Curated **million-scale multimodal and text datasets** for pretraining and supervised fine-tuning.
- Implemented a **speculative-decoding training pipeline** for internal autoregressive models.

Deep Learning and Research Lab ([DLR Lab](#)), Bilkent University

July 2023 – Present

Supervised by [Aysegul Dundar](#).

- Developed **CLIPAway**, a training-free object-removal method using background-focused CLIP embeddings to suppress hallucination of removed objects.
- Co-developed **RoPECraft**, transferring motion to diffusion transformers through trajectory-guided warping and optimization of rotary positional embeddings.
- Developed **BeyondMasks** to evaluate causal and physical consistency in video object removal, including residual shadows, reflections, and other after-effects.

Research Mentoring & Academic Service

Research Mentor, [MARS Programme](#), Cambridge AI Safety Hub

July 2026 – Present

- Mentor two researchers on **agentic LLM introspection**, studying whether models can detect and reason about steering and behavioral interventions through tool calls.

Undergraduate Mentor, Bilkent University

2024 – Present

- Mentored **CS 490: Individual Research Study** projects leading to a **NeurIPS 2025 publication** and reproducible research code.

Reviewer, NeurIPS

2025, 2026

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Bilkent University

2023 – 2025

- CS 464: Introduction to Machine Learning (Fall 2025); CS 484: Introduction to Computer Vision (Fall 2024); CS 224: Computer Organization (Spring 2024, 2025); CS 101: Algorithms and Programming I (Fall 2023).
- Received the **Best Teaching Assistant Award (2025)** among 120 teaching assistants.